David Kim

Staff Backend Engineer

david.kim@hey.com | +1 (415) 555-0621 | github.com/dkim-eng | Seattle, WA

SKILLS

Python	Go	Java	Rust
Django	FastAPI	gRPC	Kafka
PostgreSQL	DynamoDB	Redis	Elasticsearch
AWS	Microservices	System Design	CI/CD

EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Amazon (Alexa AI), Seattle | 2020 – Present

- • Architected high-throughput intent recognition service (Go + gRPC) handling 2M requests/second.
- • Led migration of 3 Python Django monoliths to Go microservices — 70% latency reduction.
- • Mentored 6 junior engineers; conducted 50+ technical interviews.

Senior Backend Engineer

Twilio, San Francisco | 2018 – 2020

- • Built SMS delivery pipeline processing 4B messages/month using Kafka + Python consumers.
- • Designed idempotent webhook retry system reducing duplicate deliveries by 99.2%.

Backend Engineer

Yelp, San Francisco | 2016 – 2018

- • Maintained core review API (Django) serving 200M monthly users.
- • Optimised 40+ slow PostgreSQL queries; reduced p99 API latency from 2.1s to 180ms.

PROJECTS

Nexus — Distributed Task Queue (Open Source, Rust)

- • High-performance task queue built in Rust with Redis backend; 2,800+ GitHub stars.
- • Benchmarks show 3× throughput vs Celery on identical hardware.

System Design Interview Guide (Technical Blog)

- • Published 24 in-depth system design case studies (Notion-style DB, Twitter feed, Uber dispatch).
- • 45k monthly readers; referenced in 3 engineering newsletters.

FastORM — Async Python ORM Experiment

- • Prototype async ORM for PostgreSQL using asyncpg with Pydantic v2 models.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Computer Science

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh | 2014 – 2016

Specialisation: Distributed Systems & Cloud Computing

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering

University of Washington, Seattle | 2010 – 2014